RESOLUTION NO. 2799

TERMINATING THE MANDATORY COVID-19 VACCINATION FOR EMPLOYEES AND VOLUNTEERS.

WHEREAS, pursuant to Resolution No. 2672 on October 7, 2021, the Town of Friday Harbor, with exceptions, prohibited employees and volunteers from engaging in work for the Town after December 7, 2021 if the employee or volunteer had not been fully vaccinated against COVID-19; and

WHEREAS, while COVID-19 appears to be permanent in our nation, high vaccination rates and recent advances in medicine, including the widespread availability of vaccines for adults and children, as well as treatments like antivirals, have stabilized the number of hospitalizations; and

WHEREAS, on October 31, 2022, Governor Inslee rescinded Proclamation 20-05, proclaiming a State of Emergency for all counties throughout the State of Washington as a result of COVID-19 outbreak in the United States and also rescinded all COVID-19 emergency proclamations issued pursuant to Proclamation 20-05; and

WHEREAS, on May 5, 2023, the World Health Organization announced an end to the global health emergency for COVID-19; and

WHEREAS, on May 11, 2023, the Biden-Harris Administration ended the COVID-19 Public Health Emergency declaration and lifted the COVID-19 vaccine requirements for Federal employees, Federal contractors and international air travelers; and

WHEREAS, on May 11, 2023, Governor Inslee rescinded the vaccination requirements for State employees; and

WHEREAS, on May 19, 2023, San Juan County terminated its state of emergency and rescinded its mandatory vaccinations for employees and volunteers; and

WHEREAS, the Town Council finds that the use of emergency powers, including the mandatory COVID-19 vaccination of Town employees and volunteers, is no longer needed to manage the risks of COVID-19 for the reasons set forth above;

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the Town Council Resolution No. 2672 establishing mandatory COVID-19 vaccinations for Town of Friday Harbor employees and volunteers is hereby terminated.

ADOPTED this 1st day of June 2023.

TOWN OF FRIDAY HARBOR

Raymont C. Jackson, Mayor

SEAL of the
Town of Friday Harbor
ATTEST:

Amy E. Taylor, Town Clerk